

Daivi Sampada

(Lecture Notes)

-Shailja Tewari, Lecturer CIS

Introduction:

The avid desire to improve yourself is what makes humans, human. From time immemorial, men have strived hard to improve themselves and their surroundings and this very inherent desire to improve led to human evolution. In this age of technological advancements and fierce competition, if you cannot help yourself you may be left far behind. We encounter many western models of Personality development, but is there any Indic Model of Personality Development? Let's find out.

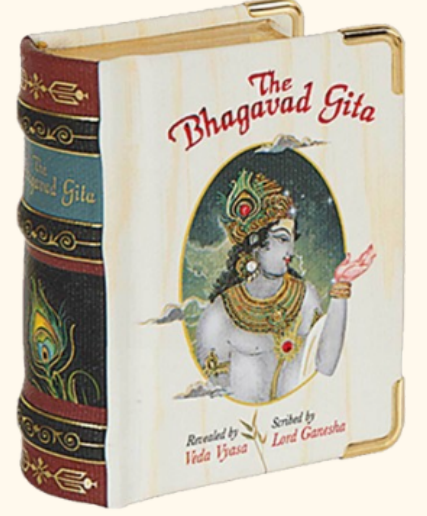
1. The 26 Divine Traits for Personality Development:



अभयं सत्त्वसंशुद्धिः ज्ञानयोगव्यवस्थितिः।
दानं दमश्च यज्ञश्च स्वाध्यायस्तप आर्जवम्॥16.1॥

अहिंसा सत्यमक्रोधस्त्यागः शान्तिरपैशुनम्।
दया भूतेष्वलोलुप्त्वं मार्दवं ह्रीरचापलम्॥16.2॥

तेजः क्षमा धृतिः शौचमद्रोहो नातिमानिता।
भवन्ति सम्पदं दैवीमभिजातस्य भारत॥16.3॥



2. The Act of Fearlessness: *Abhay*

A. Introduction

“What are you afraid of?” We have so many fears. Some of them are large and some of them are small. Fear of **failure** in exams or career, **rejection** by peers or society, fear of **judgment** or **criticism** of appearance, **disappointing** family or teachers, being **left out** or **not fitting in**, **speaking up** in class or in public. These fears may look small, but they can **limit confidence**, **block growth**, and **create anxiety**.

B. Stories from Past, Lesson for Today:



Sambhaji Maharaj: Sambhaji Raje crowned as the Chhatrapati of Marathas in 1681 after Shivaji's death, Sambhaji Maharaj did not merely inherit the throne, but the smoldering legacy of Swarajya.

The remarkable things that Sambhaji Maharaj achieved in his short life had far-reaching effects on the whole of India. He valiantly faced the 8 lakh strong army of Aurangzeb and defeated several Mughal chieftains in the battlefield forcing them to retreat.

Because of this, Aurangzeb remained engaged in battles in Maharashtra, thus keeping the rest of India free from Aurangzeb's tyranny for a long time. Sensing weakness, the Mughals kept pursuing him, and he was captured after nine years of resistance.

Sambhaji and his adviser Kavi Kalash were captured by the Mughal troops on 1 Feb 1689. Sambhaji endured 40 days of savage torture at the hands of Aurangzeb, but still, he would neither surrender nor convert. He was chained, his body parts were cut off, his nails were pulled out, and hot iron rods were placed in his eyes. To add to his agony, salt was rubbed into his wounds.

Moral: Sambhaji Maharaj chose Swarajya over fear, being a king he was trained in Indian scriptures which made him rooted to Dharma and remain fearless for achieving the higher goal.



The Chote Sahibzaade: In the Battle of Chamkaur (1704) the chaar Sahibzade participated. Guru Gobind Singh, including his elder sons Sahibzada Ajit Singh and Sahibzada Jujhar Singh, defended themselves against a much larger Mughal force at Chamkaur Fort, they fought with unparalleled bravery and eventually achieved martyrdom. The Mughal forces also arrested Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Sahibzada Fateh Singh, aged 9 and 7, respectively along with Mata Gujri Ji. As per history, it is quite unclear how Mata Ji and Sahbzade met Gangu.

A former servant, Gangu, a Kashmiri pandit, saw them and suggested that they come with him to his village. They were grateful for his help and went with

him. However, the servant breached their trust and in greed for money, then turned her and the Sahibzadeh over to Jani Khan and Mani Khan, local Mughal authorities in the town of Morinda. They were housed here in kotwali (jail). The Sahibzadeh were subjected to torture while in Mughal custody to persuade them to convert to Islam. When they refused to accept Islam, they were transferred to Sirhind, where the local Mughal emperor Nawab Wazir Khan received them. On December 26, 1705, during the early hours of the morning they were bricked alive by the orders of Wazir Khan, the Nawab of Sirhind. The place where this tragic event occurred is now observed as the Fatehgarh Sahib Gurudwara.

Moral: Despite being just children, they showed incredible courage when faced with threats. They chose to stand by their beliefs without fear, even in front of powerful enemies. Their bravery teaches us that abhay is not the absence of fear, but the strength to hold on to truth, dharma, and values even when the situation is frightening.

C. Key Takeaways:

- Fear of loss, rejection, failure, criticism, death, unknown arises due to:
Attachment (मोह), Ignorance (अविद्या) and Ego (अहंकार)

- **Steps to Overcome Fear?**

Step1: Leaving behind the desires, anger, greed, ego

Step 2: We must refrain from doing unethical deeds

Step 3: Removing the sense of 'मैं' (self-centeredness)



3. The Trait of *Damah* (Self-Restraint):

A. Introduction:

Dama refers to voluntary control over one's senses, impulses, and desires—not repression, but intelligent regulation. In a world of constant distraction (social media, consumerism), self-restraint underpins sustained focus, academic achievement, and emotional intelligence.

B. Stories for Developing Self-Restraint:



Devi Ahilyabai Holkar's life is a classic illustration: She got married at a very early age. Her husband was an intoxicated person. He died at a very early age and within a span of few days many of her family members died including her son. She transformed personal pain into public service, used resources for social good rather than personal luxury, and modeled simplicity despite royal status.

She never collapsed in sorrow but turned her pain into purposeful service and governance. Never misuse her authority or indulge in luxury, dedicated resources to public welfare, Temples and

Dharamshalas, never for personal gain. She lived simply, wore plain clothes, and engaged in spiritual practice despite royal status.

Moral: The story of Ahilya Bai Holkar reflects self-control and discipline rule even during times of personal loss and political pressure. Her life teaches us that true strength lies in inner restraint, thoughtful decision-making, and serving others with calm dignity.

The Self-Restraint of Arjuna: Arjuna belonged to the Chandravamsha and was the spiritual son of Lord Indra. Arjuna prays to Indra to acquire celestial weapons, and pleased by his devotion, Indra invites Arjuna to his abode. Indra



advises Arjuna to acquire the Gandharva Astra as he would have to spend one year of his exile in incognito mode (“Agyata vaas”). This would require Arjuna to take lessons in music and dance from the Gandharva Chitrasena and Apsara Urvashi.

During the training session, Urvashi falls for Arjuna. She is the finest of all maidens in Indra's court and highly desired by all the gods. Yet, Urvashi is mesmerized by Arjuna's handsome face. She falls in love with Arjuna and starts craving for obtaining Arjuna as her husband. Arjuna respectfully declines her proposal, so Urvashi becomes angry and curses Arjuna. The curse later becomes a boon, allowing Arjuna to live in disguise as Brihannala, a dance teacher, during the Pandavas' incognito year.

Moral: Arjuna's respectful rejection of Urvashi's proposal shows self-control and mastery over desires. His disciplined mind and commitment to dharma remind us that true greatness comes from honoring values over temptations.

B. Key Takeaways:



- Dama restrains harmful impulses (e.g., greed, violence).
- It allows individuals to accept differences and avoid reactive behavior, thus maintaining peace.
- Dama empowers to gain control over impulses rather than being their slaves, leading to freedom, not restriction.



4. Trait of Daan (Charity)

A. Introduction:

Daan is not mere giving away of surplus possessions; it is a conscious cultivation of generosity and relinquishment of attachment (Aparigraha). It is a training for the mind to become less attached to material things and more oriented toward collective well-being.

B. Stories from Ancient Texts:

Rishi Dadichi: The devtas (gods) were once tormented by a powerful demon named Vritrasura, who had gained immense strength due to a boon that made him invincible to any ordinary weapon. Desperate and defeated, the devas approached Lord Vishnu for guidance. Vishnu revealed that the only weapon capable of killing Vritrasura would have to be made from the bones of a sage who had accumulated immense spiritual power through penance and tapasya.

The devas then turned to Rishi Dadhichi. When they explained their dilemma, Dadhichi without hesitation, agreed to give up his life so that his bones could be used to forge the Vajra (thunderbolt), a divine weapon. Before doing so, he entered deep meditation and willingly left his mortal body. From his bones, Vishwakarma made the Vajra, which was then wielded by Indra to slay Vritrasura and restore peace and order in the heavens. Rishi Dadhichi's sacrifice is celebrated as the highest form of daan not of wealth, but of life itself offered with complete detachment and for the welfare of all.



Moral: The story shows the deepest form of daan, offering oneself completely for the welfare of others. He gave up his life so that his bones could be used to create a weapon to protect the world from destruction. His sacrifice reminds us that the truest form of giving lies in selflessness, where the good of all is placed above one's own comfort or gain.



King Shibi: The story of King Shibi's *daan* is a shining example of compassion, justice, and supreme self-sacrifice in Indian tradition. Renowned for his unwavering commitment to dharma, King Shibi was once tested by the gods themselves. To examine his virtue, Lord Indra and Agni took the forms of a dove and a hawk respectively. One day, the frightened dove flew into King Shibi's court, seeking protection from the pursuing hawk. The hawk, upon arrival, demanded that the king return its rightful prey. King Shibi, bound by his duty to protect those who seek refuge, refused to surrender the dove.

The hawk then reasoned that denying it food would be an injustice to its own dharma as a predator. In response, King Shibi offered his own flesh as a substitute. To honor both duties saving the dove and feeding the hawk he placed his own body on one side of a scale and the dove on the other. Miraculously, no amount of flesh could balance the scale until Shibi finally offered his entire body. Moved by his selflessness and firm sense of justice, the gods revealed their true identities and blessed him. King Shibi's *daan* was not merely of flesh, but of complete self-offering for the sake of righteousness, making his story a timeless symbol of true kingship and moral courage.

Moral: King Shibi's story is a shining example of *daan* rooted in compassion and unwavering commitment to dharma. When a helpless dove sought his protection, he didn't hesitate to offer his own flesh to save its life, even when tested by the gods. His actions teach us that true generosity means giving without hesitation, even at great personal cost.

C. Key Takeaways:

- Dama restrains harmful impulses (e.g., greed, violence).
- It allows individuals to accept differences and avoid reactive behavior, thus maintaining peace.
- Dama empowers to gain control over impulses rather than being their slaves, leading to freedom, not restriction.



5. Akrodha (Eradicating Anger)

Anger is a normal, human response, but unchecked, it leads to harm, regret, and broken relationships. Scriptures do not recommend denial of anger, but its transformation into calm, wise response. Unlike mere suppression, Akrodha is the conscious transformation of anger into inner peace and wise action. This quality is extensively discussed in the file, emphasizing its practical necessity and higher purpose.

A.Stories as a Torch-bearer for Eradicating Anger:



Draupadi's Wisdom: When Ashwathama killed her five sons, emotions of grief and rage surged. Arjuna, moved by fury, prepared to kill Ashwathama. However, Draupadi insisted on showing compassion: she reasoned that being a son of a Brahmin, Ashwathama's life should be spared to stop the cycle of pain for others, notably his mother. Her approach reflected self-control and empathy over revenge. Her story teaches us that true strength lies not in reacting with anger, but in rising above it with dignity and determination.

Moral: Instead of being consumed by rage, she turned her pain into strength, becoming a voice for justice. She forgives Ashwatthama resulting in her inner peace instead of burning in the fire of revenge.

- **Tale of the Mongoose:** Once upon a time, in a small village, there lived a Brahmin, his wife, their infant son, and a pet mongoose. The mongoose was loyal and affectionate, and over time, he became a beloved member of the family. One day, while the Brahmin's wife had to go out briefly, she left her baby asleep in the cradle and asked her husband to watch over him. The Brahmin, however, had to leave for a short while, and in that gap, the mongoose stood guard near the baby. While the house was quiet, a venomous snake slithered in, approaching the infant. The brave mongoose immediately attacked the snake and, after a fierce fight, killed it, saving the child's life. Proud of his deed, the

mongoose waited at the door, his mouth stained with the snake's blood. Just then, the Brahmin's wife returned. Seeing the blood on the mongoose's mouth and not finding the baby in sight, she jumped to a terrible conclusion that the mongoose had harmed her child. Overcome by grief and rage, without checking further, she struck the mongoose with a heavy pot, killing him instantly. Moments later, she entered the room and saw her baby safe and sound, sleeping peacefully, and the dead snake nearby. Realizing the truth that the mongoose had saved her child, not harmed him she was filled with remorse and guilt.

Moral: This story teaches us that acting in haste and anger can lead to irreversible loss and deep regret. We must learn to control our emotions, especially anger, and think calmly before making decisions. Patience and understanding can prevent unnecessary harm and preserve what is truly valuable.

B. Key Takeaways:

- Anger, while a natural emotion, often arises when ego (अहंकार), fascination or desire (मोह), and greed (लोभ) are hurt.
- Akrodha is *not* about denying or bottling up anger. Instead, it focuses on cultivating a balanced mind that chooses tranquility over impulse.
- Mastering anger builds emotional intelligence and resilience. It allows one to lead life, rather than be led by fleeting emotions.
- It fosters trust and harmony within families, teams, and societies by preventing unnecessary conflicts and grudges.



You cannot see your reflection in boiling water. Similarly, you cannot see the truth in a state of anger. When water calms, clarity comes.



6. Kshama (Forgiveness):

Forgiveness is not portrayed as weakness or passivity but as a conscious, courageous act of letting go of resentment and anger toward those who may have caused harm. It promotes mental peace, emotional health, and overall well-being. Cultivating forgiveness improves interpersonal relationships, fostering trust, and cooperation.

A. Examples of Forgiveness:

- Vasishth and Arundhati:
<https://youtu.be/q2y-nDXag?si=LwKZtMTRstWm974n>
- Krishna and Shishupal: Lord Krishna displayed profound forgiveness toward Shishupal, who insulted him repeatedly. Rather than reacting immediately with anger or violence, Krishna exercised patience and forgiveness until the end of Shishupal's allotted offenses. This illustrates that forgiveness can coexist with justice and timely action but requires persistence and equanimity.
<https://youtu.be/-tHBv5IqP3I?feature=shared>

B. Key Takeaways:

- In workplaces, forgiveness is essential to resolve conflicts, encourage teamwork, and maintain a positive environment.
- Kṣhamā embodies the strength of inner peace and moral courage.
- It promotes emotional regulation, reducing anger and the desire for retaliation thereby fostering personal well-being. It is essential for conflict resolution and reconciliation, both at interpersonal and societal levels, promoting harmony and unity.



7. Natimaanita (Non-Arrogance):

- Ancient scriptures such as the Bhagavad Gita, Mahabharata, and Dharmashastra emphasize humility as essential for spiritual progress and social harmony.
- Humility is closely connected with eradicating ego (अहंकार) which is the root cause of arrogance and related negative traits.
- The absence of arrogance promotes a clear perception of truth and fosters wisdom

A. Examples of Non-Arrogance:

Humility of Lord Hanuman: The humility of Lord Hanuman is one of the most endearing and inspiring aspects of his character, making him not only a mighty warrior but also the epitome of devotion and selflessness. Despite possessing extraordinary strength, wisdom, and divine powers, Hanuman never displayed arrogance or pride. His life is a testament to the belief that true greatness lies in surrender and service, not in boasting of one's abilities. In the Ramayana, when Hanuman returns after discovering Sita in Lanka, he doesn't take credit for his heroic feat.

Instead, with folded hands, he attributes his success entirely to Lord Rama's grace, calling himself a mere servant who followed his master's command. Similarly, when he carries the entire mountain to save Lakshmana's life, he does not seek praise or recognition. His only concern is whether Rama and Lakshmana are safe. Even when offered rewards by Rama, Hanuman humbly declines, requesting only to remain forever at the Lord's feet, in eternal service. In many instances, he introduces himself simply as "the servant of Rama," never highlighting his own identity, power, or lineage. This deep humility, despite his divine status, makes Hanuman a timeless symbol of bhakti (devotion), teaching us that the highest form of strength is found in humility and the pure joy of selfless service.



Moral: Hanumanji's life reflects freedom from pride, through his deep humility despite his unmatched strength and divine power. It shows that true greatness lies in serving others with devotion and humility, without seeking recognition or praise for one's abilities.

- **Story of Kalidasa:** As per Kalidasa's (Raghuvamśa):



क्व च मे सूर्यप्रभवो वंशः, क्व चाल्पमतिः । तितीर्षुर्दुस्तरं
मोहादुडुपेनास्मि सागरम् ॥

Meaning: "Where is the illustrious Solar Dynasty (which I seek to narrate), and where is my small intellect? Foolishly, I attempt to cross this unfathomable ocean (of poetic endeavor) with a tiny raft (my limited skill).

Here, Kalidasa humbly acknowledges that his literary ability is not of his own doing alone, but is dependent on the blessings of the divine. This invocation reflects a deep humility he does not boast of his skills.

In essence, Kalidasa's humility is visible not just in words of modesty, but in the tone, depth, and sensitivity of his poetry he never places himself above his subject. Instead, he offers himself as a devoted instrument through which beauty, knowledge, and emotion can flow, guided by the divine.

Moral: Kalidasa remained humble even after gaining immense wisdom and fame. Genuine wisdom is marked not by arrogance but by humility, as true knowledge deepens one's respect for others and the world.

B. Key Takeaways:

Nātimānitā signifies true humility, a state of being free from ego and the need for superiority over others. This trait is crucial for balanced leadership, where influence is earned through character, not dominance or self-glorification. In education, Nātimānitā cultivates an atmosphere of collaboration over competition, fostering peer learning and mutual respect.



LECTURE SUMMARY:

Trait	English Meaning	Key Example	Takeaway for Students
अभय (Abhay)	Fearlessness	Sambhaji Maharaj, Chote Sahibzaade	Act despite fear, see larger purpose
दम (Dam)	Self-Restraint	Ahilyabai Holkar, Arjuna	Control impulses; stay mindful
दान (Daan)	Charity	Dadhichi, Shibi	Important for Societal Development
अक्रोध (Akrodh)	Anger Mastery	Draupadi, Tale of Mongoose	Avoid harmful outbursts
क्षमा (Kshama)	Forgiveness	Krishna, Arundhati	Forgive for inner peace, but not always.
नातिमानिता (Naatimaanita)	Humility	Hanuman, Kalidasa	Stay humble regardless of achievement

